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Personas

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What are Discovery Q-Cards?

This asset is a sales-ready guide for how to have more effective discovery calls, with background and messaging for each of our key buyer personas.

Elements and where they help

Research & Discovery Call Prep

Discovery Conversation

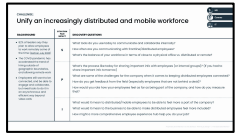
Persona Profile Cards

Get to know each persona with an overview of responsibilities, typical titles found on LinkedIn, and key challenges

Impacts & Critical Events

Identify emotional and rational drivers and potential events for each of the personas that you can listen for and validate on discovery calls

Challenge Q-Cards



Tap a list of specific discovery questions and context to uncover pain points, determine the impact the prospect is looking for, and effectively guide the conversation

Pocket Stories

Pull up succinct customer examples to share while on calls, referring to similar personas that experienced similar pains and achieved the impact they need.

How to use Q-Cards

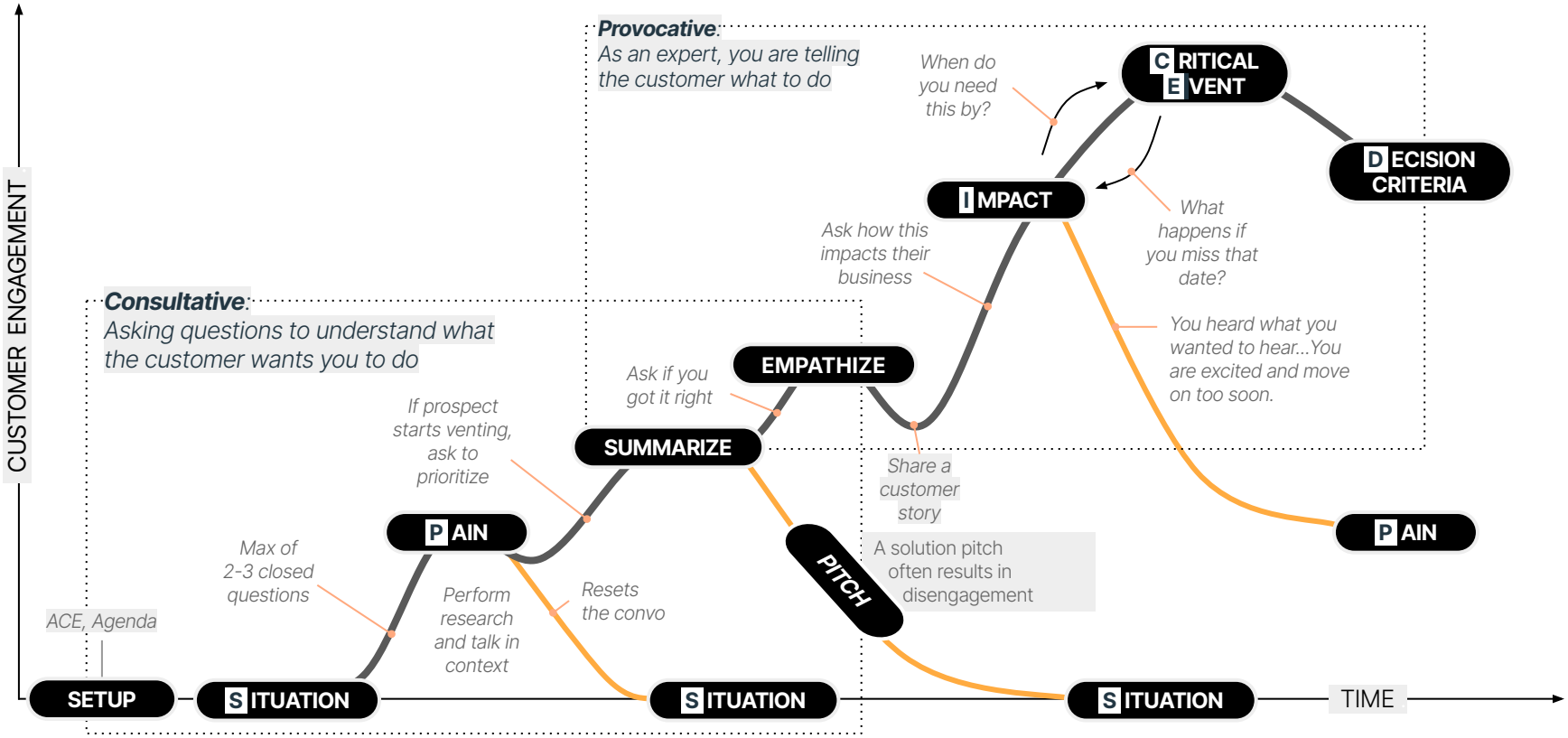
Identify the Persona you'll be talking with:

1) Determine priority challenge by reviewing Situation questions (based on research already done)
2) Confirm understanding of Situation in conversation with the persona
3) Ask Pain questions and spark deeper conversation
4) Summarize, then tell Pocket Story to help persona see potential impact
5) Ask impact questions to confirm needs and fit with our solutions

BLUEPRINT

SPICED Framework

TIP: *Executives do not like being questioned. They want you to have the "consultative info" so you can "provoke" them with out-of-the-box thinking.*



The 3 Types of Discovery Questions

S P I

01 SITUATION

- These questions set the context for what you're about to talk about
- Generally answered with a 'yes', 'no', or a fact

02 PAIN

- These questions often start with 'how' or 'what'
- They help the prospect to provide more detail on the emotional or rational pain points they are experiencing

03 IMPACT

- These questions refer to the ultimate impact that it would have on their business
- Can refer to either a positive impact of taking action (e.g., ability to capture more revenue) or negative impact of not taking action (e.g., customers having a poor support experience with a payments partner)

Key Personas & Top Challenges

Finance Leader

1. It's difficult to make informed decisions without accurate, real-time spend data
2. Managing all the different spending accounts and cards (globally) is a job in itself
3. Giving employees more control over spend is a good idea, but it's been too risky to pursue
4. Driving adoption of spend tools is difficult, which can lead to poor compliance

Controller
(Chief Accounting Officer)

1. Our team spends too much time each month just closing the books
2. Visibility into spend is delayed and inaccurate
3. Current integrations are clunky, broken, or non-existent
4. Spend policies aren't well-known or being followed

Spend Manager
(Procurement, HR)

1. The employee spending experience isn't great, adoption is low
2. We don't have visibility into where money is going against specific programs or depts
3. Spend policies aren't well-known or being followed
4. We're not getting the best rewards/rebates

Finance Leader

Finance Leader

WHAT THEY DO

- Own and direct financial, administrative, and risk management operations of the company
- Accurately and compliantly close the books and report out to the C-Suite
- Oversee financial planning, analysis, and reporting to make strategic operating and financing decisions - strategic partner to the CEO
- Mitigate financial risk, cut costs (improve profit), and forecast future spend, including setting budgets
- Transform finance from being seen as an enforcer, police, blocker to an innovator and enabler of growth

LINKEDIN TITLES

Chief Financial Officer (CFO)
Chief Accounting Officer
Head of Finance
VP of Finance
Finance Director

TOP CHALLENGES

- It's difficult to make informed decisions without accurate, real-time spend data
- Giving employees more control over spend is a good idea, but it's been too risky to pursue
- Managing all the different spending accounts and cards (globally) is a job in itself
- Driving adoption of spend tools is difficult, which can lead to poor compliance

OUR VALUE PROP

- 100% compliant. 0 receipt chasing. 100+ countries
- Cards and spend management teams actually love
  - All your spend, all in one place - From T&E to procurement
  - Keep teams compliant and on budget
  - Deliver an experience loved by your team
  - Close the books faster and automate workflows
  - Manage global spend, seamlessly

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What they care about | Finance Leader

EMOTIONAL IMPACT

Benefits the person first, and the company second
E.g., Easier and faster for Accounting team to create reports

- **Reduce internal complaints:** Better experience = easier to use = less hassle for employees
- **Praise for being tech forward:** implementing innovative tools after long history of painful systems and processes
- **Shift perception of finance:** policy police → enablers of culture, growth, innovation
- **Save team's time** with automation, better visibility, policy controls, etc.
- **Less confusion, more clarity:** clearer, integrated spending process and policy
- **Better control, compliance** = ease of mind
- **Show up across the organization**: deliver value to a large pool of employees

RATIONAL IMPACT

Benefits the company first, and the person second
Measurable; usually increasing revenue, decreasing costs, improving the customer experience
e.g., Saves $1M per year with simplified reporting

- **Consolidate solutions and vendors** → save costs, time managing partners
- **Save costs** on seat price
- **Meet trends in employee spending:** more and more access to categories of spend and more options - digital first, workforces distributed and virtual, global expansion - vs. fighting it with bigger fences, walls, restrictions, etc.
- **Improve efficiency and productivity of finance teams** through automation, controls, and visibility
- **Increase employee engagement:** deliver a delightful experience for employees by providing them clarity into spend limits and policies without significant overhead

CRITICAL EVENT

Critical Event is an event that forces an action or response *to achieve a business impact. If no action is taken, there is a negative result.*

- Mergers, acquisitions, divestitures
- Existing contract renewing
- Changing regulatory requirements
- Entering new regions, markets
- Macro-economic forces - markets down and cost cutting, RIFs, travel ramping up, etc.
- Round of growth, hiring, increased spending
- Corporate initiatives - cost savings, streamlining process, modernization
- Legal issues, fines, penalties, infractions

PERSONA	JOBS TO BE DONE	POCKET STORIES
Finance Leader	Enable all spend in one place	*Coming Soon*

CHALLENGE QCARD

It’s difficult to make informed decisions without accurate, real-time spend data.

BACKGROUND

- Finance Leader wants detailed visibility and ability to breakdown and analyze
- Likely have some visibility, but delayed; can’t make decisions fast enough; need more timely, accurate reports
- Visibility and adoption go hand-in-hand; Low visibility, bad data on spending caused by employees spending outside of CC programs, disorganized, slow with expense reports
- Company is spending a lot on T&E; CFO has pressure to monitor budgets and ensure they’re on target
- Want to look at patterns, trends, figure out how to better control spending

DISCOVERY QUESTIONS

SITUATION

Max of 2-3 closed questions

Set the conversation

What tools or technologies do you use to get visibility on spend and budgets?

Who is in charge of gathering spending data and reports?

How frequently do you looking at spending data and trends?

How do you break out spending – by department, region, or budget?

PAIN

Get customer talking

Summarize and empathize (mirror)

Share a pocket story

What’s your process for making decisions about spending and budgets?

What kind of data or insights do you wish you could get to help with decision-making?

What’s preventing you from getting deeper visibility and insights into spending?

IMPACT

Explore the impact to their business (positive or negative)

Confirm interest in getting positive impact or avoiding negative

What would it mean to the business if you could get deeper and faster spending reports and insights?

How would your decision-making be impacted by better spending data and insights?

How would more data-driven decision making on spending benefit the business?

CHALLENGE QCARD

Managing all the different spending accounts and cards (globally) is a job in itself.

PERSONA	JOBS TO BE DONE	POCKET STORIES
Finance Leader	Enable all spend in one place Manage spend with a system built for global	DoorDash

BACKGROUND

- 56% of global companies are fully remote or hybrid
- 74% of finance teams want a better way to manage expenses
- Need to organize spending across company, break down by depts., use tools across locations, manage local card issues, fees, roadblocks (declines), currency visibility, translation, etc.
- Need to support people in the field to have what they need, spend less time
- Unlock spending and give wider guardrails, freedom to invest for the business - still controls and policy in place to protect company and prevent fraud
- Rather than asking for approvals for every little thing, get budget process in an easy-to-use tool

DISCOVERY QUESTIONS

SITUATION

Max of 2-3 closed questions

Set the conversation

What technologies are you using to manage accounts payable/expenses/spending?

How many employees do you have globally? Are you looking to expand to other regions?

Are you able to break out spending by department, region, or budget?

What's the average time it takes for an employee to get reimbursed for an expense?

PAIN

Get customer talking

Summarize and empathize (mirror)

Share a pocket story

What's the process for a remote/non-HQ employee to get reimbursed? What are the high-level steps?

What are your biggest obstacles to streamlining spending?

If Global: How does managing spend internationally differ from the way you manage spend domestically? What do those differences mean for your employee and your (finance/accounting) team?

If Global: What spending/expense issues have you had across different regions?

IMPACT

Explore the impact to their business (positive or negative)

Confirm interest in getting positive impact or avoiding negative

What impact would it have on the business if you left your spend processes in their current state?

How would more streamlined spending processes affect your ability to scale?

What would more efficient spend processes mean to the business?

PERSONA	JOBS TO BE DONE	POCKET STORIES
Finance Leader	Keep teams compliant and on budget	DoorDash

CHALLENGE QCARD

Giving employees more control over spend is a good idea, but it's been too risky to pursue.

BACKGROUND

- Mains goals - mitigate fraud/risk, spend less time on low value tasks, empower growth
- Make sure they comply with rules, have a sense of control, can tie spending to returns, reduce vendor profile/consolidate, and easily reconcile the books
- Remote workers makes it more difficult - introduce more travel, stipends, etc., but also lose sense of closeness/control
- Automation helps reduce time on low value tasks, and also reduce errors
- About being data-driven; able to see trends, monitor spending, transparency into operation

DISCOVERY QUESTIONS

SITUATION

Max of 2-3 closed questions

Set the conversation

Does your company face challenges with employees spending in-policy? Why?

What tools/technologies do you use to manage spend and budgets?

What percentage of employees are remote or hybrid?

Who do you give corporate cards to? Why/for what purpose?

PAIN

Get customer talking

Summarize and empathize (mirror)

Share a pocket story

Where does the company most need to improve compliance with spending policies?

What compliance issues or problems would you (your team) most like to get rid of?

What's the relationship like between finance and other departments? How is finance viewed in the company?

If no corporate card program: Why haven't you implemented corporate cards? What are the biggest risks or blockers?

IMPACT

Explore the impact to their business (positive or negative)

Confirm interest in getting positive impact or avoiding negative

What would it mean for the company if you were not able to improve financial discipline?

How would better visibility of spending impact the business?

To what extent would a stronger culture of financial discipline change things?

CHALLENGE QCARD

Driving adoption of spend tools is difficult, which can lead to poor compliance.

PERSONA	JOBS TO BE DONE	POCKET STORIES
Finance Leader	Deliver an experience loved by your team.	DoorDash

BACKGROUND

- User experience drives everything - if they like and use it, it's easier for finance, better data, more compliant, etc.
- Typical reactions to dealing with corporate spending process and company cards are not great
- Usually not very fast, manual - physical sheet, and staple receipts
- Many employees see what other companies are doing, see trends, and know there's a better way
- Managers also want to avoid awkward conversations of "why did you get 1st class"; don't want to enforce/remember policy
- Want a similar experience to other tools they use - Zoom, Slack, Docusign

DISCOVERY QUESTIONS

SITUATION

Max of 2-3 closed questions

Set the conversation

What spending and/or budgeting platform(s) do you use?

Do you have a corporate credit card program?

How satisfied are employees with the spending and credit card programs, on a scale of 1 to 5? (1= hate it, 5 = love it)

Who handles feedback or complaints about the budget and spend tools?

PAIN

Get customer talking

Summarize and empathize (mirror)

Share a pocket story

What is the experience like for employees to spend against their budgets or manage expenses? What are the steps?

What feedback do you get from employees, managers, and the finance team about their experience managing spend and budgets?

Where do you think the spend and budget experience could improve?

IMPACT

Explore the impact to their business (positive or negative)

Confirm interest in getting positive impact or avoiding negative

How does employee dissatisfaction with budget and spend tools impact the business?

How would improved satisfaction with the budget and spend tools experience change things?

To what extent would more intuitive and easier-to-use budget and spend tools affect overall employee satisfaction?

Controller

(Chief Accounting Officer)

Controller
(Accounting)

WHAT THEY DO

- Manage all aspects of accounting incl. accounts payable - owner of all spend management activities and key champion of software solution
- Own all aspects of the month, quarter, and year-end close process
- Ensure continued compliance with all federal, state, and local tax requirements
- Work with employees to collect, review, manage approvals, and troubleshoot expenses and reimbursements
- Gather data for reports on spending and budgets for the CFO, leadership, and others

LINKEDIN TITLES

Controller

Head of Procurement

Head of Accounting & AP

VP/Director of Accounting

TOP CHALLENGES

- Our team spends too much time each month just closing the books
- Current integrations are clunky, broken, or non-existent
- Visibility into spend is delayed and inaccurate
- Spend policies aren't well-known or being followed

OUR VALUE PROP

- Make your accounting team a hero, not a blocker
- Make the monthly close faster - without sacrificing the financial visibility and control that finance teams need
- Automate reconciliation with custom category mapping and seamless ERP & HRIS integrations
- Stay compliant by default with auto-generated receipts and custom spend policies
- Reduce excessive controls and restrictions to create a great experience for employees, managers, and controllers to deploy budgets without having to memorize the expense policy
- Easily monitor employee spend across the entire org

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What they care about | Controller

EMOTIONAL IMPACT

Benefits the person first, and the company second
E.g., Easier and faster for Accounting team to create reports

- **Close books faster:** Streamlined process, better experience closing the books, less aggravating
- **Less tedious work:** increased usage, adoption of spend tools, automation, policy controls = easier for accounting
- **Less hassling and bugging people:** no tracking down paper receipts or playing detective to get info from the team
- **Shift perception of accounting:** money police → enablers of culture, growth, innovation
- **Less confusion, more clarity:** clearer, integrated spending process and policy
- **Better control, compliance** = ease of mind
- **Show up across the organization**: deliver value to a large pool of employees

RATIONAL IMPACT

Benefits the company first, and the person second
Measurable; usually increasing revenue, decreasing costs, improving the customer experience
e.g., Saves $1M per year with simplified reporting

- **Close books faster:** save time and cost on accounting personnel (less overtime)
- **Better visibility into spending**: optimize programs and save money
- **Increase accounting team satisfaction**: spend time and energy on strategic, high value tasks
- **Lower risk of fraud**: controls and alerts for unethical, or illegal spending
- **Increase user/employee satisfaction:** better employee experience = adoption, compliance, and savings

CRITICAL EVENT

Critical Event is an event that forces an action or response *to achieve a business impact. If no action is taken, there is a negative result.*

- Too many issues related to spending, card use, or visibility
- Ramping up events, travel, etc. involving spending and reimbursement
- Big internal or external event with travel and spending involved
- Change in growth trajectory
- End of month/year books closing, financial statements
- Audit, and being prepared

CHALLENGE QCARD

Our team spends too much time each month just closing the books.

PERSONA	JOBS TO BE DONE	POCKET STORIES
Controller	Close the books faster, automate workflows	Avenue One

BACKGROUND

- Many tasks involved in closing books are a waste of smart peoples' time
- Whether $5 or $100 - has to go to accounting for rubber stamp or investigation
- If there are issues, kicked back for fixes, delays everything
- Many accounting teams are lean, so reviewing expenses 1 by 1, making sure they're in policy, has impact on other areas
- User experience is key - minimizing the friction with employees to get needed info
- Innovative teams strive to get data, process, and tools to where they're doing real-time reconciliation (or at least daily)

DISCOVERY QUESTIONS

SITUATION

Max of 2-3 closed questions

Set the conversation

How many expenses are you processing in an average month?

How long does it take employees to submit an expense on average? How old is the average expense?

Who is usually involved in reconciliation/closing the books at the end of the month, quarter, or year?

How long does it usually take for the team to close the books?

PAIN

Get customer talking

Summarize and empathize (mirror)

Share a pocket story

What's your process for reconciling/closing the books? What are the high-level steps?

What's painful about the process of closing the books?

What's the experience like for the accounting team during reconciliation time?

What would you like to improve about the process of closing the books?

IMPACT

Explore the impact to their business (positive or negative)

Confirm interest in getting positive impact or avoiding negative

What happens if you don't improve the reconciliation/closing process?

How would a faster reconciliation/closing process affect the team?

What would be the impact on the business of more streamlined expenses and reconciliation?

CHALLENGE QCARD

Visibility into spend is delayed and inaccurate.

PERSONA	JOBS TO BE DONE	POCKET STORIES
Controller	Enable all spend in one place	Empire Portfolio Group Avenue One

BACKGROUND

- Accounting teams usually responsible for data reconciliation - collecting and organizing info for purposes of reporting, closing books, or answering questions (compliance)
- Visibility and spend program adoption go hand-in-hand; Low visibility, bad data on spending is caused by employees booking outside of programs, disorganized, slow with expense reports
- Finance and Accounting need to look at patterns, trends, figure out how to better control spending, and how to manage treasury

DISCOVERY QUESTIONS

SITUATION

Max of 2-3 closed questions

Set the conversation

What technology/solutions do you use to manage and track spending?

Who's in charge of organizing spending data and/or gathering it for reporting?

How often do you get different reports or snapshots of spending?

Do you have any blind spots in your visibility of spending across the company? What are they?

How long does it take for employee spend to become visible to accounting/finance?

PAIN

Get customer talking

Summarize and empathize (mirror)

Share a pocket story

What's the process like for gathering data and creating reports on spend?

How do you analyze and review spending reports and insights with stakeholders?

What is the most difficult insight or piece of data to get? What would you like to provide visibility on but haven't been able to?

What's the most time-consuming, or frustrating, aspect of building spend reports?

IMPACT

Explore the impact to their business (positive or negative)

Confirm interest in getting positive impact or avoiding negative

How is the current lack of spend visibility impacting the business?

What would it mean to be able to reconcile spending data easier and faster?

To what extent would real-time visibility on spending change things?

CHALLENGE QCARD

Current integrations are clunky, broken, or non-existent

PERSONA	JOBS TO BE DONE	POCKET STORIES
Controller	Close the books faster, automate workflows	Empire Portfolio Group

BACKGROUND

- Disconnected tools make more work for accounting
- They want automation and tools that save time or manual work
- Ideal to fix things from the start, rather than afterwards - wading through data and trying to make sense of everything
- Want to be proactive vs. reactive
- For global orgs, with more systems and data, can be even more disconnected and burdensome

DISCOVERY QUESTIONS

SITUATION

Max of 2-3 closed questions

Set the conversation

What systems do you use to manage spending/accounts payable? (Expense, Travel, Ledger, ERP, etc.)

Which of those systems are integrated/connected?

Do you work with a global team? Are different regions using the same solutions?

Who is responsible for managing technology for the finance team? Do you have a dedicated resource, or a central/shared IT team?

What percentage of your work would you say is automated vs. manual?

PAIN

Get customer talking

Summarize and empathize (mirror)

Share a pocket story

What's the process for managing expenses? What's a typical journey of an expense?

What's the most time-consuming, tedious part of managing expenses? What part of the process do you wish you could automate?

Where do different systems/tech play a role in the expense process?

How do you handle moving data/info across multiple systems?

IMPACT

Explore the impact to their business (positive or negative)

Confirm interest in getting positive impact or avoiding negative

How does data friction between accounting/finance tools affecting the business?

How would more integrated tools and data impact your process?

What would it mean to the business to be able to automate more of the expense process?

CHALLENGE QCARD

Spend policies aren't well-known or being followed.

PERSONA	JOBS TO BE DONE	POCKET STORIES
Controller	Keep teams compliant and on budget	Empire Portfolio Group

BACKGROUND

- Policies help control spending, reduce risk of legal violations, fraud, or inappropriate activity
- Accounting needs to balance enforcing policy with limiting administrative burden for employees and managers
- With personal cards employees are paying out of pocket, and taking risk on getting reimbursed/not
- 66% of employees have not read their company's spend policy
- Policies can be complicated, hard to remember, or not updated often enough to match market realities
- Without controls, Accounting has to manually review and then address issues with employees or managers

DISCOVERY QUESTIONS

SITUATION

Max of 2-3 closed questions

Set the conversation

Do you have an expense/spending platform? Which one(s)?

Do you have a corporate card program? Which one?

Do your programs have policy control capabilities?

Do you have a documented policy on spending/T&E?

Who's in charge of implementing and enforcing spending policy?

PAIN

Get customer talking

Summarize and empathize (mirror)

Share a pocket story

How have you implemented and enforced your spend policies?

What approvals need to happen for different spending? How do those happen?

How do you handle travel or expenses that are out-of-policy?

If no corporate card program: Why haven't you implemented corporate cards? What are the biggest risks or blockers?

IMPACT

Explore the impact to their business (positive or negative)

Confirm interest in getting positive impact or avoiding negative

What would it mean for the company if you continued with the current policy and approval setup?

How would better policy controls embedded in your spend platform change things?

How would more automated approvals impact the business?

Spend Manager

(Procurement, HR)

Spend Manager

(Procurement, HR)

WHAT THEY DO

- Manage and source vendors, equipment, software, and services to keep business running smoothly
- Negotiate contracts and work with vendors to secure favorable terms and options
- Design and administer travel and spending programs and tools for the company
- Work with Finance to create travel, spend policy and ensure compliance
- Track travelers for safety under duty-of-care requirements
- Analyze spend across categories, and report on expenses and trends in spending

LINKEDIN TITLES

Head of Procurement
VP/Director of Procurement
Procurement Manager
Chief HR Officer (CHRO)
VP/Director of HR
Accounts Payable Manager

TOP CHALLENGES

- The employee spending experience isn't great, adoption is low
- Spend policies aren't well-known or being followed
- We don't have visibility into where money is going against specific programs or depts
- We're not getting the best rewards/rebates

OUR VALUE PROP

- Best-in-class, human-centric UX that employees will proactively use for expenses, reimbursements, travel, bills, POs, and invoices
- Enable easy spending with vendor cards so employees are empowered to grow the business while staying compliant
- Reduce excessive controls and restrictions to create a great experience for employees, managers, and controllers to deploy budgets without having to memorize the expense policy
- Advanced budgets capabilities including: pre-approved spend, custom approval workflows, easily enforced expense policies, automated receipts and memos *(see notes for more detail)*

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What they care about | Spend Manager

EMOTIONAL IMPACT

Benefits the person first, and the company second
E.g., Easier and faster for Accounting team to create reports

- **Achieve cost savings goals:** get incentives, improve status, feel good
- **Career improvement:** better frame accomplishments to managers, leadership
- **Be more strategic:** Less time spent on administrative issues - evolve, fulfill the vision for role
- **Add value to the business:** get rewards, value back for spending
- **Improve perception in the company:** Seen less as bottleneck/gatekeeper, easier, more 'thank you's' vs. complaints
- **Enjoy work:** easy to use tools, less frustration with complex, bad admin experience
- **Know where travelers are:** relief knowing that they're safe (duty of care)

RATIONAL IMPACT

Benefits the company first, and the person second
Measurable; usually increasing revenue, decreasing costs, improving the customer experience
e.g., Saves $1M per year with simplified reporting

- **Better visibility into spending:** optimize programs, vendors and save money with integrated spending data
- **Rewards, rebates, cash back:** money, value to invest back in the company
- **Save time:** spend more time on high value tasks
- **Save costs on personnel** with automation and self-serve tools
- **Improved adoption of spend programs:** keeping in policy, preventing fraud/risk
- **Save manager time, effort** on approvals and escalations
- **More accurate budgeting** and forecasts

CRITICAL EVENT

Critical Event is an event that forces an action or response *to achieve a business impact. If no action is taken, there is a negative result.*

- Project milestones - corporate card or travel program in place
- Big internal or external event with travel and spending involved
- Travel ramping up (seasonal or market-related)
- Budget season
- Contract expiring with existing travel platform
- Big team events, annual SKOs
- Funding, growth, expansion into different markets, geos (U.S., EMEA, etc.)
- Expenses getting out of control

PERSONA	JOBS TO BE DONE	POCKET STORIES
Spend Manager	Deliver an experience loved by your team	Lightspeed

CHALLENGE QCARD

The employee spending experience isn't great, adoption is low.

BACKGROUND

- Many companies looking to get away from complex platforms that are hard to use - don't get used
- Go toward more easy-to-use, automated tools that match their experience in other parts of the business - Zoom, DocuSign, Slack, etc.
- Better user experience = better adoption = easier to manage spend, see data and trends
- Using spend tools is required to get reimbursed, but making it easy to submit in a timely manner, accurately, in policy, makes everyone's lives easier

DISCOVERY QUESTIONS

SITUATION

Max of 2-3 closed questions

Set the conversation

How many expenses per month does your company handle?

Do you have an expense/spending platform? Which one(s)?

Do you have a corporate card program? Which one?

How would employees rate the spending experience on a scale of 1 to 5? (1 = terrible, 5 = fantastic)

PAIN

Get customer talking

Summarize and empathize (mirror)

Share a pocket story

What's the process like for employees to spend and get reimbursed?

Do you allow spending outside of the spend tools/programs? What are the reasons that happens?

What do you hear from employees about their experience with the spending process?

If no corporate card program: Why haven't you implemented corporate cards? What are the biggest risks or blockers?

IMPACT

Explore the impact to their business (positive or negative)

Confirm interest in getting positive impact or avoiding negative

How is the current spending experience for employees impacting your processes?

What would it mean for the business if employees had a more pleasant, easy spending experience?

What impact would increased adoption of spend programs have on the business?

PERSONA	JOBS TO BE DONE	POCKET STORIES
Spend Manager	Enable all spend in one place	*Coming Soon*

CHALLENGE QCARD

We don’t have visibility into where money is going against specific programs or departments.

BACKGROUND

- Spend Managers love more toys, options, and insights on spending patterns
- Usually painful to get visibility into vendors being used - don’t always have the data to properly manage vendors
- Without data, not able to be strategic, locked into a process
- Want to identify duplicate vendors, employee preferences for negotiation, find places to optimize spending
- Visibility would also help understand spending across seasons, regions, teams to better forecast and build budgets
- Adoption is key; Low visibility, bad data caused by employees booking outside of programs

DISCOVERY QUESTIONS

SITUATION

Max of 2-3 closed questions

Set the conversation

Who on the team is responsible for managing vendor relationships and negotiating rates?

Do you organize by spend category, team/business unit, or another way?

Are you able to track spending against vendors and negotiated rates? What tools do you use to track?

How often do you get/generate reports on spending by vendor and category?

PAIN

Get customer talking

Summarize and empathize (mirror)

Share a pocket story

What’s the process for evaluating, negotiating with, and approving new vendors?

What is the most difficult insight or piece of data to get on spending to help with vendor management?

What would you like to be able to do with your vendors and/or categories that hasn’t been possible?

IMPACT

Explore the impact to their business (positive or negative)

Confirm interest in getting positive impact or avoiding negative

How does low/poor visibility on spending against vendors and categories affect the business?

What impact would better spending tool adoption have on your ability to manage vendors?

How would increased visibility on spending and vendor usage change things?

CHALLENGE QCARD

Spend policies aren't well-known or being followed.

PERSONA	JOBS TO BE DONE	POCKET STORIES
Spend Manager	Keep teams compliant and on budget	Lightspeed

BACKGROUND

- Policies help control spending, reduce risk of legal violations, fraud, or inappropriate activity
- Spend Manager needs to balance enforcing policy with limiting administrative burden for employees and managers
- With personal cards employees are paying out of pocket, and taking risk on getting reimbursed/not
- 66% of employees have not read their company's spend policy
- Policies can be complicated, hard to remember, or not updated often enough to match market realities
- Without controls, Accounting or Spend Manager has to manually review and then address issues with employees or managers

DISCOVERY QUESTIONS

SITUATION

Max of 2-3 closed questions

Set the conversation

Do you have an expense/spending platform? Which one(s)?

Do you have a corporate card program? Which one?

Do your programs have policy control capabilities?

Do you have a documented policy on spending/T&E?

Who's in charge of implementing and enforcing spending policy?

PAIN

Get customer talking

Summarize and empathize (mirror)

Share a pocket story

How have you implemented and enforced your spend policies?

What different approvals need to happen for different spending? How do those happen?

How do you handle travel or expenses that are out-of-policy?

If no corporate card program: Why haven't you implemented corporate cards? What are the biggest risks or blockers?

IMPACT

Explore the impact to their business (positive or negative)

Confirm interest in getting positive impact or avoiding negative

What would it mean for the company if you continued with the current policy and approval setup?

How would better policy controls embedded in your spend platform change things?

How would more automated approvals impact the business?

PERSONA	JOBS TO BE DONE	POCKET STORIES
Spend Manager	Keep teams compliant and on budget	*Coming Soon*

CHALLENGE QCARD

We're not getting the best rewards and rebates.

BACKGROUND

- Rewards, rebates and affinity can heavily influence the decision to go with one card program over another
- Might have benchmarks, goals to hit for value back from spend tools
- Ideally get to the point where rebate/cash back pays for program costs
- Feels good to be able to get value back for the company
- May prefer to have rewards/redeemable point (incentivize employees, purchase things for business) OR get cash back directly
- The days are likely over of employees using their own cards and getting individual rewards

DISCOVERY QUESTIONS

SITUATION

Max of 2-3 closed questions

Set the conversation

Which business spending platform do you use?

Do you have a corporate card program?

How many employees have access to corporate cards?

How much are you spending on corporate cards in an average month/quarter?

Do you get cash back, rebates or rewards on purchases?

PAIN

Get customer talking

Summarize and empathize (mirror)

Share a pocket story

If currently getting rewards: What are the high-level terms of your rewards/rebates?

If rewards/points: How do you use the rewards?

What would you love to see improved about your affinity/rewards program?

IMPACT

Explore the impact to their business (positive or negative)

Confirm interest in getting positive impact or avoiding negative

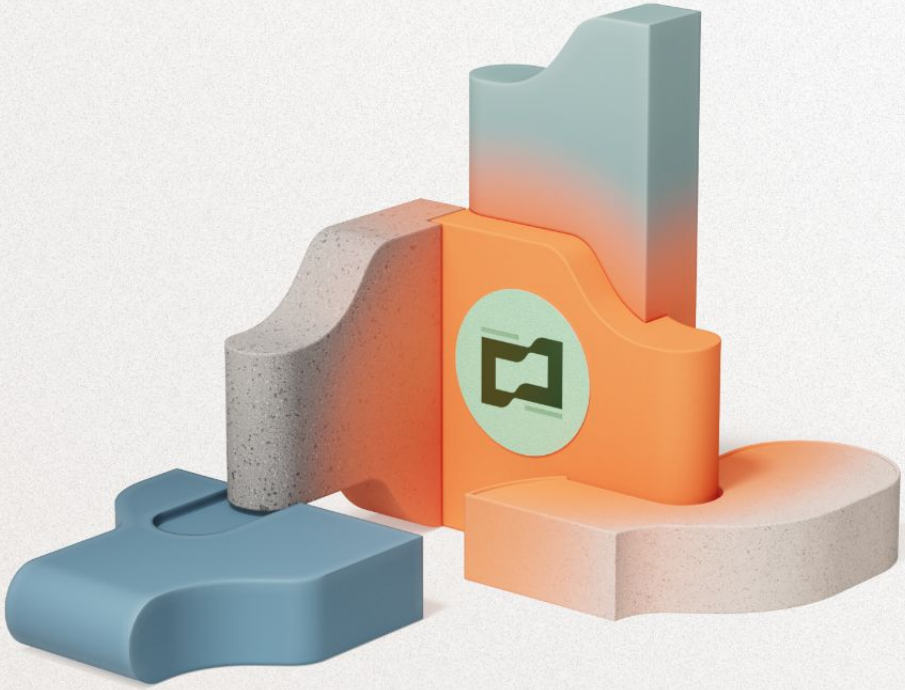
What would it mean to the company to get better rewards/rebates terms on corporate card spending?

What would be the impact of getting additional cash back on corporate card spending?

How would an improved experience for taking advantage of benefits and rewards impact the business?

Personas

Pocket Stories



CUSTOMER POCKET STORY

Lightspeed

NOT PUBLIC Use this story for 1-on-1 prospecting (conversation and emails only)

KEY CHALLENGE

The employee spending experience isn't great, adoption is low

Spend policies aren't well-known or being followed

PERSONA

Spend Manager

INDUSTRY

Technology

[USE CASE/PRODUCT/TYPE]

Coming Soon

SITUATION

Pierre, Global Accounts Payable Manager at Lightspeed

- Commerce platform for retail, hospitality and golf merchants around the world
- Publicly traded company
- 2,500 employees
- Based in Canada with offices across the globe
- Had grown very quickly and were looking to streamline processes and tools

PAIN

Pierre's team **used many different systems and banks to manage their finance and accounting processes.**

Because of this, their **admins/users were frustrated and confused about where to do things and find data.** This slowed their ability to get employees' funds, manage spending vehicles, and reconcile expenses.

The finance and accounting teams had no unified view of spending and didn't feel comfortable giving cards to employees.

Employees were also frustrated, not knowing when to go to which system for which tasks, and not knowing how to get spending approved or reimbursed. For example: if an Office Manager were trying to get a broken light fixed, they had to go through a whole process and likely wouldn't get everything fixed for weeks.

IMPACT

We worked with Pierre to implement a **single, unified system that allowed them to enforce policy, track spending, and ensure compliance.**

It gave them the confidence to roll out spend vehicles to more employees with built-in management tools. They **issued cards quickly and safely with unified, global workflows** - regardless of where the employee is - from a single source.

They **made it quicker for employees to address issues and easier for them to get things done and back to their core tasks.** The employee experience much better and accounting didn't have to worry about chasing down receipts at the employee or manager level.

Everything is compliant and they can close the book easier, faster too.

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CUSTOMER POCKET STORY

DoorDash

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KEY CHALLENGE

Managing all the different spending accounts and cards (globally) is a job in itself

Driving adoption of spend tools is difficult, which can lead to poor compliance

PERSONA

Finance Leader

INDUSTRY

Food Service

[USE CASE/PRODUCT/TYPE]

Coming Soon

SITUATION

Mike, VP of Finance at DoorDash

- Global food delivery company
- Over 9,000 employees

PAIN

As a distributed global company, it can be hard to move fast and enable people to make the right decisions in real-time.

Mike became aware that one warehouse general manager was facing challenges as he tried testing a new business offering. This manager saw an opportunity to sell & deliver ice as an add-on for customer orders.

The **warehouse manager was sent to the grocery store to buy $1,000 of ice when he learned he was not authorized for that spend on his corporate card**. He wouldn't be able to test his great idea.

Because of inflexible policies and procedures, the business couldn't align with what the customer clearly needed - something they could deliver.

To make matters worse, when he inquired to the finance team, he **was told to set up a purchase order. Five weeks later, he was still waiting for approvals and funds**.

IMPACT

Mike learned that there was a missed opportunity here and systemic issues to be addressed. Finding ways to allow innovation to thrive is a key part of nurturing fast-paced growth.

Mike sought out a partner who could help **empower employees to make the right spending decisions in real-time**. He uncovered an opportunity to use money - and quick, easy access to spend vehicles - to accelerate company growth.

Mike recognized that **no well-intentioned employee should be prevented from moving the business forward**. He learned from experience and found a way to give autonomy and power back to employees.

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CUSTOMER POCKET STORY

Empire Portfolio Group

KEY CHALLENGE

Visibility into spend is delayed and inaccurate

Current integrations are clunky, broken, or non-existent

PERSONA

Controller (Accounting)

INDUSTRY

Retail/Fitness

[USE CASE/PRODUCT/TYPE]

Coming Soon

SITUATION

Tiffany, Director of Accounts Payable, Empire Portfolio Group

- Empire Portfolio Group is a leading area franchisee of Orangetheory Fitness
- Fast-growing brand known for its signature blend of science, coaching, and technology
- Operating since 2013
- Headquartered in New York City

PAIN

Empire had been outsourcing its financial functions to third parties and **using multiple cards and payment solutions, including Amex, Chase, Venmo, and Zelle — making it difficult to track spending.**

As Empire grew, they decided it was time to **build their FinOps in-house with a modern, integrated spend management solution** that would help them run faster and with greater financial discipline across their locations.

Because Empire was starting from scratch, they needed more than a provider — they **needed a partner that would quickly implement their new solution with high-touch service**.

IMPACT

Tiffany and the team worked with us to begin implementing a complete spend management platform. They loved the ability to **delegate spending power to managers at each location with clear limits and expense policies** — making it easy for teams to do the right thing for the business.

They then rolled out tools for consolidated expense tracking and fast reimbursements. **After all the positive feedback from our employees, they accelerated the rollout of additional tools**.

Empire's controllers and managers have **real-time visibility and easy control over spending across their locations** in one place for **greater accountability and transparency from anywhere**.

Tiffany has seen a massive shift in accounts payable **from a back-office data entry function to a powerhouse of information**.

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CUSTOMER POCKET STORY

Avenue One

KEY CHALLENGE

Current integrations are clunky, broken, or non-existent

Our team spends too much time each month just closing the books

PERSONA

Controller

INDUSTRY

Real Estate/Technology

[USE CASE/PRODUCT/TYPE]

Coming Soon

SITUATION

Katherine, Controller at Avenue One

- Avenue One is an innovative property tech scale-up that provides a full-suite Single Family Rental (SFR) service platform to institutional investors
- ~200 employees in the US and Canada
- Deploys billions of dollars for their clients across the world's largest asset class

PAIN

The corporate card that Katherine's team used **wasn't able to integrate deeply with their NetSuite ERP, and their finance team was slowed down by reviews and manual work as a result.**

They had to download the card detail, review every purchase, manually tag NetSuite GL accounts, and import that file to NetSuite every month.

It wasn't sustainable — especially with their FX workload increasing.

Katherine knew they needed a user-friendly expense management solution that could fully integrate with NetSuite to **drive automation and efficiency, and free up the finance team.**

IMPACT

Katherine and the team were able to find a solution that they **could sync with Netsuite in minutes**. It enables global employee spending with built-in controls that make expense management easier for managers and the finance team.

They were also **able to automate data flow to improve speed and accuracy**. With that automation, the finance team has significantly decreased their manual work, freeing them up to be more strategic. **Katherine estimates savings of 10-15 hours on reconciliation every month**.

They have **more control and visibility over purchases across departments, teams, and borders**. And as a result, employees and managers rarely need the finance team's help because they **have an easy self-service solution** at their fingertips.

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